

Southside Middle School 8th Grade Recognition Ceremony

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hmiJPWnhaBc
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Target Category	mcs

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Meeting Summary: Southside Middle School Class of 2025 Eighth Grade Recognition

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to the event.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:00:10](#) The event was formally opened as the eighth-grade recognition ceremony for Southside Middle School, celebrating the class of 2025.
- **Attendance:** Administration, eighth-grade teaching staff, school counselors, and student speakers were present. Parents and community members attended via digital live stream.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - [00:00:14](#) Musical performance by the Panther Pride Band.
 - [00:03:58](#) Special recognition and round of applause for the eighth-grade teaching and support staff.

- [00:08:11](#) Musical performance by the Panther Singers.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not applicable.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(This celebratory recognition ceremony did not feature formal legislative votes, ordinances, or resolutions.)

- [00:04:49](#) **Student Address: Emma Judge**
 - **Presenter:** Emma Judge, Student Speaker.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reflecting on the transition from elementary to middle school, Judge discussed the challenges of navigating sixth-grade anxieties, seventh-grade disruptions (including shifting math teachers and the onset of COVID-19 remote learning), and the ultimate return to in-person activities. She expressed gratitude to teachers, administrative support, and choir instructor Mrs. Dorn, while highlighting inclusive school groups like the Rainbow Panther Club.
 - [00:11:34](#) **Student Address: Katie Brown**
 - **Presenter:** Katie Brown, Student Speaker.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brown spoke about the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on schooling, praising the administration's efforts to keep operations as normal as possible so students could experience in-person learning, bus transportation, and extracurriculars when many schools remained virtual. She encouraged her peers to embrace the upcoming transition to high school with responsibility and purpose.
 - [00:14:14](#) **Student Address: Ms. Helm**
 - **Presenter:** Ms. Helm, Student Speaker.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Helm shared her unique perspective as a student who transferred to Southside Middle School during her eighth-grade year amidst quarantine and a new environment. She thanked Dr. K and the administration for prioritizing in-person learning and urged her classmates not to be discouraged by setbacks, reminding them that building a community takes time and hard work.
 - [00:17:20](#) **Eighth-Grade Class Recognition & Student Cross-Stage**
 - **Presenter:** School Counselors and Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** [00:18:08](#) through [00:28:03](#) Individual recognition and presentation of eighth-grade students crossing the stage to transition into incoming ninth graders.
 - [00:28:27](#) **Special Student Honors:** [00:28:32](#) Nevaeh Wood and [00:28:35](#) Tommy Williams were formally recognized as the two outstanding eighth-grade students of the school year for their exemplary citizenship, academics, and overall contributions.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment or citizen forum period was held during this celebratory school ceremony.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **00:29:45** Closing remarks and words of wisdom delivered to the graduating eighth graders, referencing literature by Mary Oliver, Marianne Williamson ("Our Deepest Fear"), and Michelle Obamas' principles on embracing personal potential and stepping into ninth grade.
 - **Adjournment: 00:32:59** The ceremony concluded with final congratulations extended to the incoming freshman class.
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